

Tour du Mont Blanc — Visual Topo Guide

This companion guide adds route relief maps to the standard Tour du Mont Blanc trail guide. The 170 km circuit crosses France, Italy, and Switzerland around the Mont Blanc massif in 7 to 11 days. The overview map below shows the full counter-clockwise loop from Les Houches, with Courmayeur and Champex marking the Italian and Swiss legs.

Tour du Mont Blanc — Full Route Overview



Aurora Outfitters - Topographic Trail Guide - synthetic relief for illustration

Figure 1 — Full route overview, counter-clockwise from Les Houches.

Days 1–3 — France: Les Houches to Refuge des Mottets

The opening three days climb out of the Chamonix valley through Les Contamines and over the Col du Bonhomme before dropping to Refuge des Mottets on the Italian border. The segment map beside this paragraph traces that climb — note the steady elevation gain from Les Houches through Les Contamines, then the sharper pitch up to Refuge du Bonhomme.

TMB Days 1–3 — Les Houches to Refuge des Mottets (France)

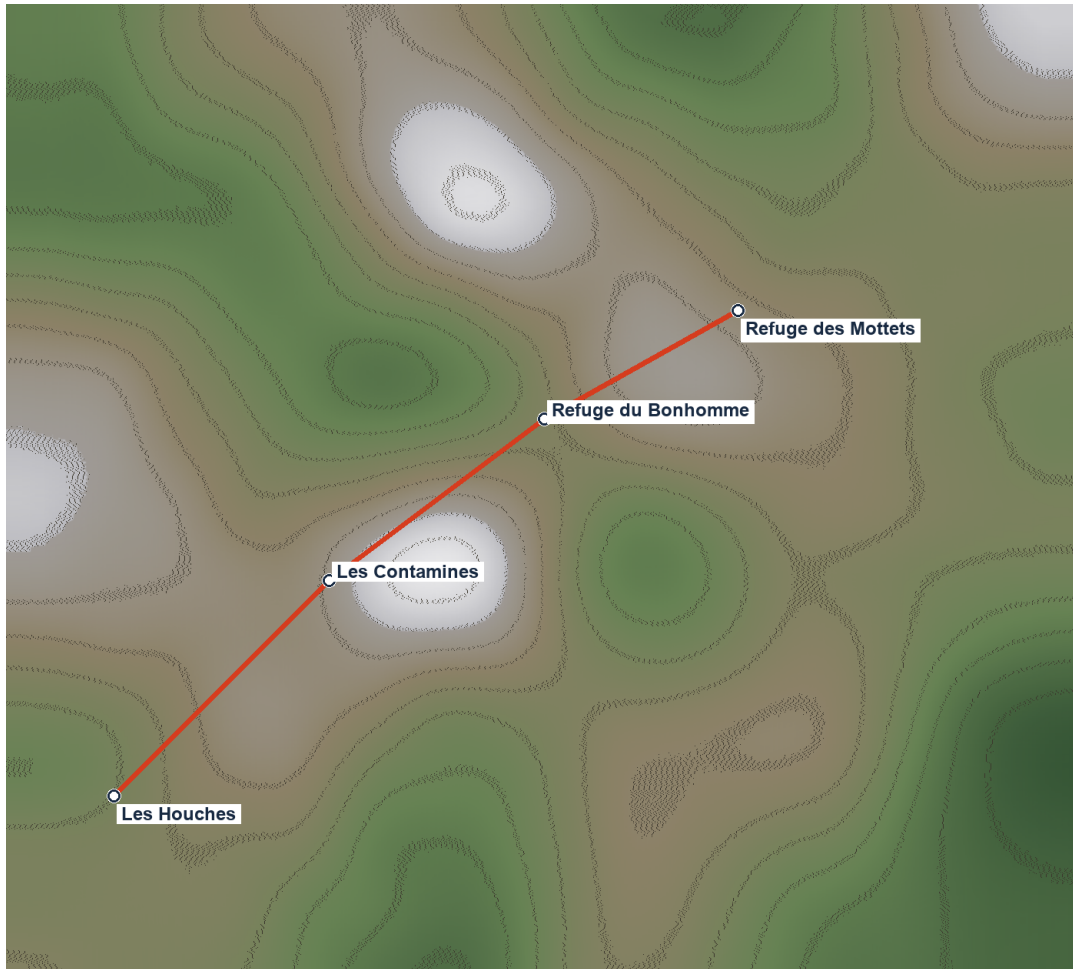


Figure 2 — Days 1–3 segment relief map, France.

Days 4–6 — Italy to Switzerland: Courmayeur to Champex

From Courmayeur the route climbs past Refuge Bonatti — widely considered the best single viewpoint on the TMB — before crossing into Switzerland at La Fouly and descending to the lakeside village of Champex. The map beside this paragraph shows the Italy-to-Switzerland border crossing and the Bonatti balcony trail.

TMB Days 4–6 — Courmayeur to Champex (Italy → Switzerland)



Figure 3 — Days 4–6 segment relief map, Italy → Switzerland.

Days 7–10 — Final Ridge: Champex to Les Houches

The final four days cross back into France via the Col de Balme and finish along the ridge above Chamonix, with sweeping views back over the full massif on the descent into Les Houches. The segment map beside this paragraph shows that closing ridge line.

TMB Days 7–10 — Champex to Les Houches (final ridge)

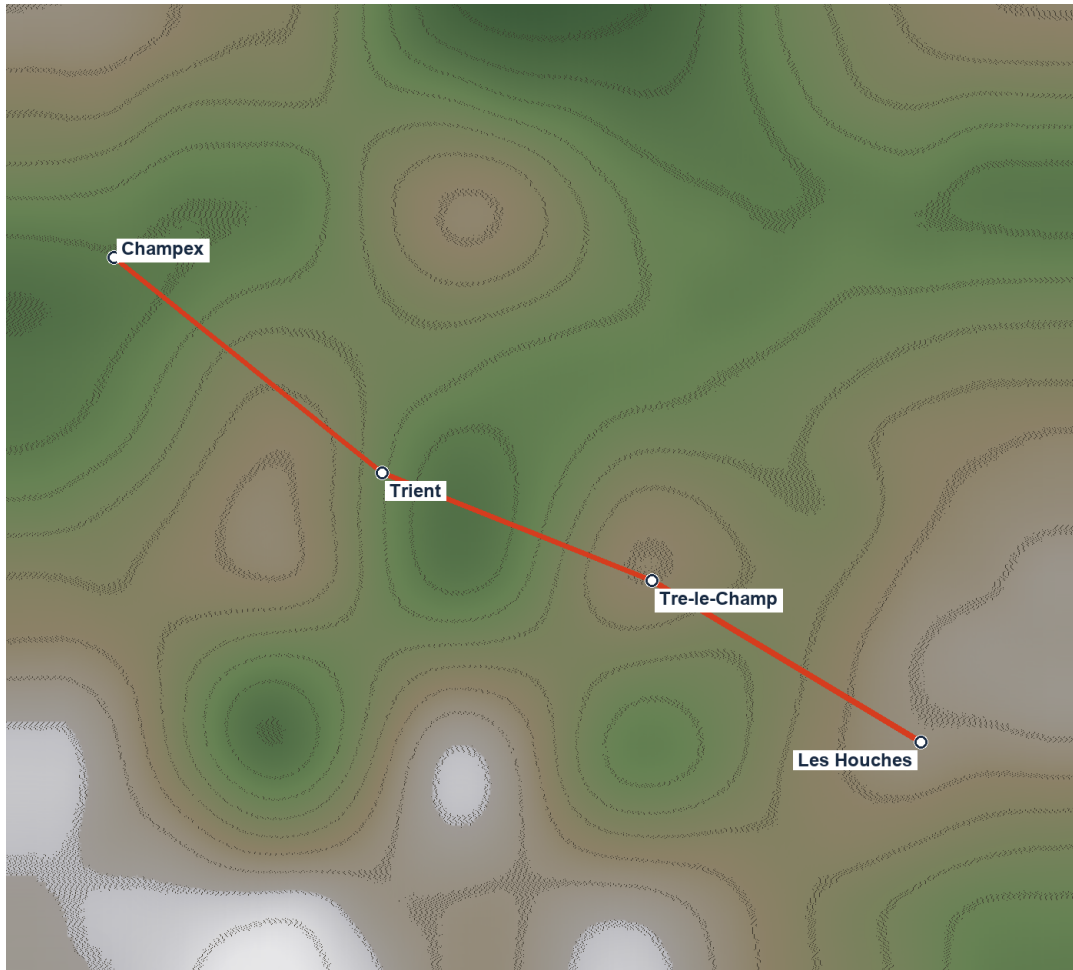


Figure 4 — Days 7–10 segment relief map, final ridge.

The elevation profile below summarises all ten days end to end — four major climbs above 2,000 m, each followed by a descent to valley-floor refuges.

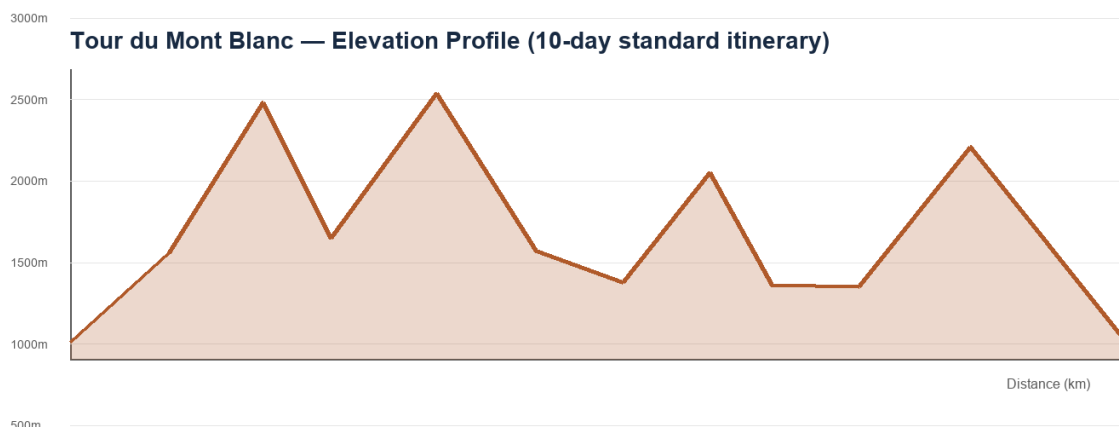


Figure 5 — Full-route elevation profile, 10-day standard itinerary.

Recommended gear: Aurora TerraTrek 7 boots and the Aurora Skyline 45L pack — see Theo Sundberg's gear notes in the standard Tour du Mont Blanc trail guide for the full kit list.